Setup

These instructions cover macOS and Windows. Platform-specific steps are noted where they differ.

1. Install R (macOS)

Option A: Homebrew

```
brew install r
```

Option B: CRAN installer

- Download the latest `.pkg` from https://cran.r-project.org/bin/macosx/
- Open the installer and follow the prompts

1. Install R (Windows)

- Download the latest `.exe` from https://cran.r-project.org/bin/windows/base/
- Run the installer and follow the prompts

2. Request an API key

Email Nicholas Warren at DISSC (dissc@yale.edu) to request an AWS Bedrock API key for Claude. **Request this before the workshop;** you'll need the key in Step 3. This key will expire after the workshop. For long-term access, contact dissc@yale.edu.

3. Configure AWS Bedrock credentials (macOS)

Copy the contents of `files/machine-setup/user/zprofile.txt` into `~/.zprofile`, replacing `TOKEN_HERE` with the API key from the previous step, then run:

```
source ~/.zprofile
```

> **Do not share your API key or commit it to version control.** Treat it like a password.

3. Configure AWS Bedrock credentials (Windows)

Open System Properties > Environment Variables > User variables and add the following, replacing `TOKEN_HERE` with your API key:

Variable	Value
`AWS_REGION`	`us-east-1`
`AWS_BEARER_TOKEN_BEDROCK`	your API key

After saving, restart any open terminals or applications so they pick up the new variables.

> **Do not share your API key or commit it to version control.** Treat it like a password.

4. Install Positron

- Download and install from https://positron.posit.co/

5. Configure Positron

> If Positron is already open, restart it after configuring credentials so it picks up the new values.

- Open Positron
  - macOS: from the Dock or Finder
  - Windows: from the Start Menu or desktop shortcut
- `File > Open Folder` and select the `faculty` folder (not the repository root)

5. Configure Positron (continued)

- Open the Command Palette (`Cmd + Shift + P` on macOS, `Ctrl + Shift + P` on Windows) and select `Preferences: Open User Settings (JSON)`
- If the file is empty, paste the full contents of `files/machine-setup/positron/settings.json` and save. If you already have settings, merge the keys from that file into your existing JSON.

6. Set up Positron Assistant

- Click the `Chat` icon in the left sidebar
- Click `Configure Model Providers`
- Select `Provider` as `Amazon Bedrock`
- Click `Sign In` under `Authentication` (credentials from Step 3 will load automatically)
- Select `Claude Opus 4.6` from the `Manage Models` dropdown at the bottom of the Chat panel

7. Start an R session

- Open an `.R` file from the project
- Select the R installation when prompted
- If not prompted: open the Command Palette (`Cmd + Shift + P` on macOS, `Ctrl + Shift + P` on Windows) and select `Interpreter: Select`, then choose R

8. Install packages

- In the R Console, run:

```
install.packages("tidyverse")
```

The example script also uses `broom` and `scales`, which are included when you install `tidyverse`.

9. Verify your setup

- In the R Console, run `library(tidyverse)`. You should see a startup message listing attached packages.
- In the Assistant chat panel, type `What is 2 + 2?` and confirm you get a response.
- If either step fails, restart Positron and retry. For credential issues, double-check that your API key is saved correctly in Step 3.